

Abhishek **BACHCHAN** Speaks His Mind



“I don’t think the amount you get paid is important. I’d much rather be spoken about for my work.”

“On the dining table, we don’t talk shop.”

menting history for posterity, so how can it be one-sided?

Q. Is it because you maintained a silence during a certain period in your career? Do you regret that silence?

AB. It was the period when the press banned me for 15 years after the Emergency. A lot of negative things were written. All that goes into the archives and becomes available material for anyone who wants to do research. The lady who did a book on me, Jessica Hines, actually found that the only record of that period was what came out in gossip magazines. Now if that is going to be the record of my little contribution, is that correct? A whole lot of that creativity fortunately is still alive because of television and people still talk about it. But where’s the gauge? If someone is going to be documenting history, they will find a gap.

Q. How’s Aishwarya amalgamated into the family, its set of friends, its particular rules?

AB Jr. There are no rules. I think the only rule that is enforced is that on the dining table, we don’t talk shop. It’s weird but a lot of people think it’s like boarding school. But we are a normal family. My parents are very open-minded. They’ve always discussed things with my sister and me. Everybody is asked for their opinion. And we try our best to have one meal together, if we are in the city.

Aishwarya. That’s beautiful. It’s rarely that everyone is doing their own individual thing. And again it’s not like some proclaimed rule. It’s just about being together.

“WHEN PEOPLE ATTACK YOU PERSONALLY, I TAKE IT AS PART AND PARCEL OF MY JOB.”

Q. How important is it for both of you that you do well in your respective careers?

AB Jr. I’ve always enjoyed her work. I’m very glad she’s busy working. People tend to forget that I’m the son of an actor, and that’s my mother. And my mother worked way after she was married, after she had my sister and me. So why would my family or I want to stop Aishwarya from acting? Being an actor, you understand another actor.

Aishwarya. This isn’t bias speaking, this is actual admiration. I feel he’s so malleable and open to the craft of acting, to doing so many different things, gaining experience. That’s something I relate to. I love the work he chooses to do. It’s never been what you would dub regular. He’s just followed his heart.

Q. And now all of you will be going off on The Unforgettable Tour in July.

AB. Yes, it’s really frightening. It’s been a while. I initiated world tours in 1981 and now almost 30 years later, we’re doing it again. But it’s because we haven’t done something together in a while. We made one appearance together at the IIFA Awards in 2005.